sink and the refrigerator (store). These three points and the imaginary lines between them, make up what kitchen experts call the work triangle. The idea is that when these three elements are in close proximity to one other, the kitchen will be easy and efficient to use, cutting down on wasted steps.

If the kitchen has only one sink, it should be placed between or across from the cooking surface, preparation area, or refrigerator (store).

No major traffic patterns should cross through the triangle.

The main goal of the triangle is efficiency. It keeps all the major work stations near the cook, without cramping the kitchen. The work triangle is also designed to minimize traffic within the kitchen so the cook is not interrupted.

Besides the work triangle, following **thumb rules** need to be considered when planning a kitchen. They are as follows:

- Work aisles should not be less than 42 inches (110 cm) for one cook, or 48 inches (120 cm) for multiple cooks.
- A sink should have a clear counter area of at least 24 inches (61 cm) on one side, and at least 18 inches (46 cm) on the other side.
- A refrigerator should have a clear counter area of at least 15 inches (38 cm) on the handle side; or the same on either side of a side-by-side refrigerator; or the same area on a counter no more than 48 inches (120 cm) across from the refrigerator.
- A stove or cook top should have a clear 15 inches (38 cm) area on one side, and at least 12 inches (30 cm) on the other side.
- At least 36 inches (91 cm) of food preparation area should be located next to the sink.
- The work flow in the kitchen must be organized in a way to gain efficiency, save time and work in a conducive environment.

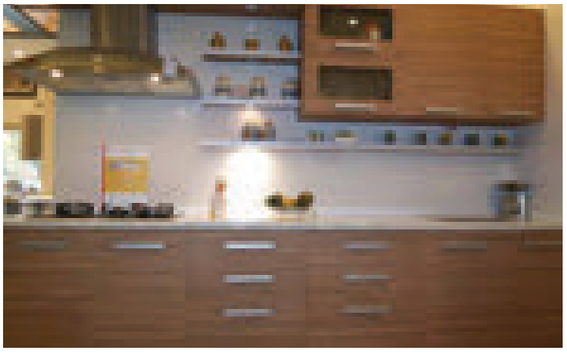


**Plate 2.11** Single-file Kitchen

## Types of kitchen layouts

- **A single-file kitchen**, also known as a one-way galley or a straight-line kitchen has the entire work triangle along one wall and is the only solution due to restriction of space. This may be common in an attic space that is being converted into a living space, or a studio apartment.
- **The double-file kitchen or two-way galley** has two rows of cabinets at opposite walls, one containing the stove and the sink, the other the refrigerator. This is the classical work kitchen and makes efficient use of space.
- **The L-kitchen** has the cabinets occupying the two adjacent walls. Again, the work triangle is preserved, and there may even be space for an additional table at a third wall, provided it does not intersect the triangle.



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